



GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT

OFFICIAL MINUTES — WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

The Grimes County Commissioners Court met on Wednesday, September 23, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox. County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order.

Call to Order

Public Comments

We look forward to hearing from the citizens of Grimes County. If you wish to make public comments you will need to submit a Public Participation Form prior to the start of the meeting and give it to the County Clerk. Public comments will be limited to 2 minutes per person. No members of the public submitted a Public Participation Form or made comments during this period.

There were no Public Comment Participation Forms submitted to the County Clerk.

Consent Agenda Items

1. Consider and take action to approve Budget Amendments and/or Line-Item Transfers.

County Judge Joe Fauth directed attention to page 12, which contained a proposed adjustment to charge outdoor security camera purchases to IT computer hardware rather than the historical courthouse budget. County Auditor Jessi Murphy confirmed the adjustment and noted there were two revised budget amendments or line item transfers under consideration, appearing on pages 11 and 12. County Judge Joe Fauth asked whether there were additional questions or concerns regarding the line item transfers and budget adjustments.

Action: Motion by Commissioner Chad Mallett to Approve the budget amendments and/or line-item transfers, including the two revised budget amendments/line-item transfers presented to the court. Seconded by Commissioner David Tullos. Carried (5-0-0).

Grimes County Health Resource Center Director - Lara Meece (PC) — Lara Meece, Grimes County Health Resource Center

2. Review and take action to approve the FY 2026 Senior Meal Rate Setting and the FY 2027 Brazos Valley Area Agency on Aging Subrecipient Agreement and authorize the County Judge as signatory. — Lara Meece, Grimes County Health Resource Center

County Judge Joe Fauth presented the FY 2026 senior meal rate setting and FY 2027 Brazos Valley Area Agency on Aging subrecipient agreement for approval and authorization of the county judge as signatory. Commissioner Phillip Cox asked whether the county attorney had reviewed the standard agreement.

Action: Motion by Commissioner Phillip Cox to Approve the FY 2026 Senior Meal

Rate Setting and the FY 2027 Brazos Valley Area Agency on Aging Subrecipient Agreement and authorize the County Judge as signatory. Seconded by Commissioner Michael Raska. Carried (5-0-0).

Grimes County Sheriff's Office - Chief Deputy Martha Smith (JF) — Martha Smith, Grimes County Sheriff's Office

3. Discuss and take action to request additional funds from the county for the Jail Inmate Medical Line Item. — Martha Smith, Grimes County Sheriff's Office

Business Manager GSO Michelle Weeks reported that the sheriff's office requires an additional fifteen thousand dollars to cover jail inmate medical expenses through the end of the month, as several bills came in larger than anticipated. County Judge Joe Fauth asked County Auditor Jessi Murphy to identify available funds, and Murphy confirmed that the court still had remaining funds in the contingency line sufficient to cover the requested amount. After asking the commissioners whether they anticipated any other upcoming expenses, County Judge Joe Fauth determined that no other surprises were anticipated. County Judge Joe Fauth indicated his intent to request the funds from the current 2026 contingency budget to cover the sheriff's office medical line item.

Action: Motion by County Judge Joe Fauth to Approve transfer of \$15,000 from the FY 2026 contingency budget to the Sheriff's Office jail inmate medical line item. Seconded by Commissioner Michael Raska. Carried (5-0-0).

4. Discuss and take action to approve a proclamation proclaiming National Night Out in Grimes County, Texas, and recognizing its importance in promoting community partnerships and public safety. — Martha Smith, Grimes County Sheriff's Office

County Judge Joe Fauth read a proclamation designating the first Tuesday in October of each year as National Night Out in Grimes County, Texas. The proclamation recognized National Night Out as a community building campaign that promotes police community partnerships and neighborhood camaraderie to enhance public safety and quality of life. The document noted that the annual event is designed to heighten crime and drug prevention awareness, generate support for local anticrime efforts, strengthen neighborhood spirit, and send a message to criminals that organized neighborhoods are fighting back. Judge Fauth emphasized that recognizing this effort annually helps maintain and grow the partnership between the community and law enforcement. Following the reading, Business Manager GSO Michelle Weeks was thanked for her work on the matter, and attendees were informed that the event would be held the following Tuesday from 5:30 to 7:30 in the Justice Parking Lot in Anderson, with a flyer to be posted on the marquee bulletin board to inform the public.

Action: Motion by Commissioner Chad Mallett to Approve the proclamation proclaiming National Night Out in Grimes County, Texas, and recognizing its importance in promoting community partnerships and public safety. Seconded by Commissioner Phillip Cox. Carried (5-0-0).

[See Exhibit A.](#)

Grimes County Judge - Joe Fauth III — Joe Fauth III

5. Consider and take action regarding the Burn Ban and authorize the County Judge as signatory. — Joe Fauth III

Current Burn Ban ordered August 19, 2026, expiring November 17, 2026.

County Judge Joe Fauth reported that despite recent rainfall in his area, he believed the

burn ban should remain in place. The existing ban, ordered August 19, 2026, is scheduled to expire November 17, 2026.

Action: **No action.**

6. Discuss and take action to properly classify Courthouse Security Deputies and make appropriate salary adjustments. — Joe Fauth III

County Judge Joe Fauth opened the discussion by acknowledging that he had overlooked the two courthouse security deputies when considering salary classifications for other law enforcement personnel. Fauth explained that the courthouse deputies perform duties comparable to constable and sheriff's deputies, including responding to courtroom situations and conducting security screenings at the Justice Center entrance. He recommended reclassifying them from level L5 to L6, which would require a budget amendment of \$17,833.27. Fauth proposed funding the adjustment by drawing from the sheriff's office machinery and equipment line, noting that the sheriff's department had approximately \$515,000 in that account and that newer vehicles required fewer repairs. Commissioner Phillip Cox raised concern about whether the reduction might constrain the sheriff's department's ability to address equipment needs. Fauth indicated that any contingency funds could restore the amount later in the year if necessary. Cox also sought clarification on whether the sheriff's office had requested the reclassification, and Fauth confirmed that while the deputies had requested equal classification with other deputies, the final budgetary decision rested with him.

Action: **Motion by County Judge Joe Fauth to Approve reclassification of courthouse security deputies from pay grade L5 to L6, authorize a budget amendment of \$17,833.27 funded from the Sheriff's Office machinery and equipment line, effective FY 2027 (October 1), and authorize the County Auditor to make the adjustment. Seconded by Commissioner Michael Raska. Carried (5–0–0).**

7. Discuss and take action on any necessary amendments to the FY2027 budget. — Joe Fauth III

County Auditor Jessi Murphy requested authorization to correct spelling errors in the FY2027 budget. County Judge Joe Fauth clarified that any corrections would be limited to typos and spelling mistakes, explicitly excluding changes to decimal points or zeros. County Auditor Jessi Murphy subsequently noted that a prior agenda item would also constitute an amendment to the budget, effective October 1 for the fiscal year 2027 period.

Action: **Motion by County Judge Joe Fauth to Approve amendment to the FY 2027 budget authorizing the County Auditor's office to make spelling/typographical corrections only, excluding changes to numerical figures. Seconded by Commissioner Chad Mallett. Carried (5–0–0).**

A motion by Commissioner Michael Raska to adjourn the meeting was made, seconded by Commissioner Phillip Cox., Carried. The meeting adjourned at 9:18 AM.

THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT ON September 23rd, 2026, ARE HEREBY APPROVED.

Barbara Kimich County Clerk

EXHIBITS

Exhibit A — proclamation national night out.pdf



Proclamation

Grimes County, Texas

National Night Out

First Tuesday of October Every Year

WHEREAS, National Night Out is a community-building campaign that promotes police-community partnerships and neighborhood camaraderie to make our neighborhoods safer, more caring places to live; and

WHEREAS, this annual event is designed to heighten crime and drug prevention awareness, generate support for, and participation in, local anti-crime efforts, strengthen neighborhood spirit and police-community partnerships, and send a message to criminals letting them know neighborhoods are organized and fighting back; and

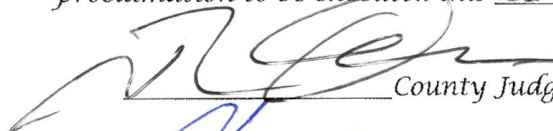
WHEREAS, the residents, law enforcement agencies, and community organizations within Grimes County are committed to working together to enhance public safety and quality of life; and

WHEREAS, National Night Out encourages residents to gather in neighborhood settings to build relationships and foster trust, contributing to a safer community; and

WHEREAS, recognizing this effort annually helps to maintain and grow the partnership between the community and law enforcement;

*NOW, THEREFORE, be it proclaimed by the Commissioners Court of Grimes County, that the first Tuesday in October of each year is hereby designated as **National Night Out** in Grimes County, encouraging all citizens, neighborhoods, businesses, and local agencies to participate in this event to promote community unity and safety.*

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the Commissioners Court of Grimes County has caused this proclamation to be executed this 23rd day of September, 2026.


County Judge Joe Fauth


Commissioner Chad Mallett, Precinct 1


Commissioner David Tullos, Precinct 2


Commissioner Michael Raska, Precinct 3


Commissioner Phillip Cox, Precinct 4